

General Rules

1. All text should be double-spaced.
2. Numbers 10 and above should be expressed in digits, while numbers nine and below should be expressed in words. The exception to this rule is that digits should be used in contexts such as measurement (3.25 cm), percentages (9%), fractions (4/4), times (5:00 PM), ages (8 years old), money (\$5), or when referring to part of a book or article (Chapter 4, Illustration 1). Titles, sentences, or text headings that begin with a number should be written out if unable to reword.
3. Statistical symbols (F , p , r , X^2 , etc.) should be italicized. The exception is Greek letters, which are not italicized.

When to Start a New Page

Table 1: Section order for an APA-formatted research report.

Section Order	Begin a New Page?	Heading (Centered)
1. Title Page		
2. Abstract	Yes	Abstract
3. Introduction	Yes	Paper Title
4. Method	No	Methods
5. Results	No	Results
6. Discussion	No	Discussion
7. References	Yes	References
8. Tables	Yes, each on a new page	None
9. Figure Captions	Yes	Figure Caption(s)
10. Figures	Yes, each on a new page	None

Ordering the Sections of an APA Research Report

Title Page

- All margins are 1 inch or greater (including bottom).
- The **running head** appears in the page header: a shortened version of the title in ALL CAPS (for professional papers; student papers omit the running head label).
- **Page number** appears in the top right corner of every page, starting with page 1.
- The **title**, author name, and affiliation should all be **centered** on the page.
- Everything is **double-spaced**.

Abstract

- Begins on a **new page** (page 2).
- The heading “Abstract” is **centered and bolded**.
- The abstract paragraph is **not indented**.
- Abstracts should not exceed 150–250 words.
- Everything is **double-spaced**.

Introduction (First Page of Main Text)

- Begins on a **new page** (page 3).
- The **paper title** is repeated at the top of the page, **centered and bolded** — there is no “Introduction” heading.
- Body text begins immediately after the title.
- First line of each paragraph is indented 0.5 inches.
- Everything is **double-spaced**.

Method Section

- Does **not** begin on a new page — continues directly after the introduction.
- The heading “Method” is **centered and bolded** (Level 1).
- Sub-headings (Participants, Materials, Procedure) are **bold and flush left** (Level 2).
- Everything is **double-spaced**.

Results Section

- Does **not** begin on a new page — continues directly after Method.
- The heading “Results” is **centered and bolded** (Level 1).
- Statistical symbols are in **italics** — r , X^2 , F , MSE , p .
- Everything is **double-spaced**.

Discussion Section

- Does **not** begin on a new page — continues directly after Results.
- The heading “Discussion” is **centered and bolded** (Level 1).
- Everything is **double-spaced**.

References

- Begins on a **new page**.
- The heading “References” is **centered and bolded**.
- Reference entries include: Author (in order with initials), date, title of article, title of publication (*italics*), volume number (*italics*), page numbers.
- First line of each reference is flush with the left margin; all subsequent lines are indented (hanging indent).
- Everything is **double-spaced**.

Tables

- Each table begins on a **new page**.
- The table number (e.g., Table 1) is **bold**, followed by the table title in *italics* on the next line.
- Statistical symbols in the table are in *italics* (e.g., M , S).

Figures

- **Figure captions** begin on a new page with the heading “Figure Caption” centered.
- The caption text (e.g., *Figure 1. Description*) is in *italics*.
- Each **figure** appears on its own new page.